

Distinguishing Tagalog valency and voice

Yining Nie

San José State University

AFLA 31 @ UMass Amherst

June 12-14, 2024

Tagalog Actor Voice (AV) verbs are most commonly formed with one of the three markers *mag-*, *ma-* and *<um>* (e.g. Pittman 1966, Cruz 1975, Rackowski 2002, Travis 2000, 2010), which can be realized with *n-* depending on aspect:

- (1) **Nag-**trabaho ang magsasaka.
MAG.PFV-work NOM farmer
'The farmer worked.'
- (2) **Na-**tunaw ang ice cream.
MA.PFV-melt NOM ice cream.
'The ice cream melted.'
- (3) S**<um>**ipa ang bata ng bola.
<UM.PFV>kick NOM child GEN ball
'The child kicked a ball.'

Nie 2020a, Nie & Hsieh to appear: This three-way morphological contrast is primarily a valency distinction

Each AV marker is limited to certain types of predicates (Nie & Hsieh to appear):

AV	UNACC	UNERG	TRANS	REFL	DITRANS
<i>mag-</i>		✓	✓	✓	✓
<i>ma-</i>	✓				
< <i>um</i> >	✓	✓	✓		

- These AV markers are reflexes of Voice⁰, responsible for introducing the external argument (Kratzer 1996)
- Kastner 2019, 2020: Voice⁰ bears a syntactic feature [$\pm D$], which governs whether it must have an external argument and gives rise to a trivalent Voice system

AV	Voice ⁰	External argument
<i>mag-</i>	Voice[+D]	Required
<i>ma-</i>	Voice[−D]	Prohibited
< <i>um</i> >	Voice[$\emptyset$]	Unspecified

We can distinguish between Philippine-type voice (Ph-voice) and valency:

Agr ⁰		Voice ⁰		External argument
AV	<um>	Voice[+D]	<i>pag-</i>	Required
	<um>	Voice[−D]	<i>pa-</i>	Prohibited
	<um>	Voice[∅]	<i>∅-</i>	Unspecified

- Voice⁰ is responsible for external argument introduction
- Agr⁰ is responsible for Ph-voice and NOM case assignment (Hsieh 2020)
- In AV, we observe Ph-voice on Agr⁰ and valency on Voice⁰ marked independently
- Ph-voice and valency are not bundled on the same head (contra Nie 2020a and to some extent Aldridge 2004, 2012)

(4) [T [Agr [Voice [V]]]]

- Not every verbal construction exhibits a three-way morphological distinction for trivalent Voice
- Co-occurrence restrictions between Agr^0 and flavours of Voice^0
 - Patient Voice (PV) Agr^0 is incompatible with $\text{Voice}[-D]$, since the latter produces an intransitive structure
- Neutralization of the trivalent Voice distinction can be syntactic or morphological

1. Introduction
2. Valency morphology
 - Trivalent Voice
 - Agr⁰ vs Voice⁰
3. Neutralizing contexts
 - Recent perfective: Morphological neutralization
 - Patient Voice: Syntactic neutralization
4. Productive causatives
 - Voice over Voice structure: Syntactic neutralization of lower Voice
5. Summary and outlook

Valency morphology

(Nie & Hsieh to appear, AFLA 30 proceedings)

Tests for diagnosing the presence of an external argument (EA):

- Agent-oriented modifiers, e.g. *nang sinasadya* 'deliberately', *maingat* 'carefully'
- Instrument phrases, e.g. *gamit ang X* 'using the X'
- Purpose clauses, e.g. *para X* 'in order to X'

(5) a. B<um>agsak ang mag-aaral *nang sinasadya*.
<UM.PFV>fail NOM student deliberately
'The student failed deliberately.'

EA

b. Na-wala ang salamangkero (*#nang sinasadya*).
MA.PFV-not.exist NOM magician deliberately
'The magician vanished (*#deliberately*).'

No EA

Tests for diagnosing the presence of an external argument (EA):

- Agent-oriented modifiers, e.g. *nang sinasadya* 'deliberately', *maingat* 'carefully'
- Instrument phrases, e.g. *gamit ang X* 'using the X'
- Purpose clauses, e.g. *para X* 'in order to X'

(6) a. B<in>uks-an ang bintana *gamit ang susi*.
<PFV>open-LV NOM window use NOM key
'The window was opened using the key.'

Implicit EA

b. B<um>ukas ang bintana (#*gamit ang susi*).
<UM.PFV>open NOM window use NOM key
'The window opened (#using the key).'

No EA

Test for diagnosing the *absence* of an external argument (EA):

- *mag-isa* 'by itself' modifier interpreted as 'of its own accord' (not 'unaccompanied') (Levin & Rappaport Hovav 1994)

- (7) a. *Mag-isa*=ng na-basag ang bintana.
by.itself=LK MA.PFV-shatter NOM window
'The window broke of its own accord.' No EA
- b. *Mag-isa*=ng na-hulog ang bata.
by.itself=LK MA.PFV-fall NOM child
'The child fell {of its own accord / #unaccompanied}.' No EA
- c. *Mag-isa*=ng nag-trabaho ang magsasaka.
by.itself=LK MAG.PFV-work NOM farmer
'The farmer worked {unaccompanied / #of her own accord}.' EA

mag- verbs always have an external argument (Travis 2000, Rackowski 2002)

Unergative, e.g. *magtrabaho* 'to work', *magtagumpay* 'to succeed'

- (8) *Maingat* na **nag**-lakad ang magsasaka.
careful LK MAG.PFV-walk NOM farmer
'The farmer walked carefully.'
- (9) **Nag**-itim ang guro ngayon *nang sinasadya*.
MAG.PFV-black NOM teacher today deliberately
'The teacher deliberately wore black today.'

Transitive, e.g. *magbitbit* 'to carry sth.', *maghugas* 'to wash sth.'

- (10) **Nag**-lu~luto sila ng sabaw.
MAG-IPFV~cook 3PL.NOM GEN soup
'They are cooking soup.'
- (11) **Nag**-bukas ako ng bintana *nang sinasadya*.
MAG.PFV-open 1SG.NOM GEN window deliberately
'I deliberately opened a window.'

mag- verbs always have an external argument (Travis 2000, Rackowski 2002)

Reflexive, e.g. *maghilamos* 'to wash one's face', *magbihis* 'to dress oneself'

- (12) *Maingat* na **nag**-ahit ang lalaki.
careful LK MAG.PFV-shave NOM man
'The man shaved (himself) carefully.'

- (13) *Maingat* na **nag**-kamot ang bata.
careful LK MAG.PFV-scratch NOM child
'The child scratched (at an itch) carefully.'

Ditransitive, e.g. *maglagay* 'to put', *magbuhos* 'to pour out'

- (14) **Nag**-bigay ang guro sa bata ng libro.
MAG.PFV-give NOM teacher OBL child GEN book
'The teacher gave the child a book.'

- (15) **Mag**-ta~tanim sila ng gulay sa hardin.
MAG-FUT~plant 3PL.NOM GEN vegetable OBL garden
'They will plant vegetables in the garden.'

mag- external arguments must be volitional (Pittman 1966)

- (16) **Nag-sara** ang { guro / *hangin } ng pinto.
MAG.PFV-shut NOM teacher wind GEN door
'The { teacher / *wind } shut a door.'
- (17) **Nag-basag** ang { bata / *init } ng baso.
MAG.PFV-shatter NOM child heat GEN glass
'The { child / *heat } shattered a drinking glass.'

ma- verbs do not have an overt external argument

Unaccusative, e.g. *matunaw* 'to melt', *mawala* 'to vanish'

- (18) a. *Mag-isa=ng na-basag ang bintana.*
by.itself=LK MA.PFV-shatter NOM window
'The window broke of its own accord.'
- b. (*#Maingat na*) *na-basag ang bintana.*
by.itself LK MA.PFV-shatter NOM window
'The window broke (*#carefully*).'
- (19) a. *Mag-isa=ng na-hulog ang bata.*
by.itself=LK MA.PFV-fall NOM child
'The child fell of its own accord.'
- b. *Na-hulog ang bata (#nang sinasadya).*
MA.PFV-fall NOM child deliberately
'The child fell (*#deliberately*).'

Some *ma-* verbs have an implicit external argument, e.g. *magupit* 'to cut hair' (Nie 2020a, see also Chen 2022 on Puyuma *u-*; Tan 2023 on Amarasi *ma-*)

<um> verbs may or may not have an external argument

Unaccusative, e.g. *sumabog* 'to explode', *lumutang* 'to float'

(20) *Mag-isa=ng b<um>agsak ang plorera.*
by.itself=LK <UM.PFV>fall NOM vase
'The vase fell of its own accord.'

(21) *Mag-isa=ng b<um>ukas ang pinto.*
by.itself=LK <UM.PFV>open NOM door
'The door opened of its own accord.'

Unergative, e.g. *tumalon* 'to jump', *umakyat* 'to go up', *umubo* 'to cough'

(22) *Um-iyak ang bata nang sinasadya.*
UM.PFV-cry NOM child deliberately
'The child cried deliberately.'

(23) *Maingat na t<um>akbo ang bata.*
careful LK <UM.PFV>run NOM child
'The child ran carefully.'

<um> verbs may or may not have an external argument

Transitive, e.g. *pumitas* 'to pick', *sumipa* 'to kick', *gumamit* 'to use'

- (24) K<um>ain ang bata ng adobo.
<UM.PFV>eat NOM child GEN adobo
'The child ate adobo.'
- (25) B<um>a~basa ang guro ng diyaryo.
<UM>IPFV~read NOM teacher GEN newspaper
'The teacher is reading a newspaper.'
- (26) P<um>atay ang magsasaka ng butiki.
<UM.PFV>kill NOM farmer GEN lizard
'The farmer killed a lizard.'

<um> verb subjects can be non-volitional, unlike *mag-* verb subjects

- (27) L<um>apit ang ulap sa araw.
 <UM.PFV>approach NOM cloud OBL sun
 ‘The cloud approached the sun.’ (Schachter & Otanes 1972: 498)
- (28) T<um>usok ang pako ng gulong.
 <UM.PFV>pierce NOM nail GEN tire
 ‘The nail punctured some tires.’

<um> verbs are never reflexive or ditransitive

Distribution of the three Tagalog AV markers

AV	UNACC	UNERG	TRANS	REFL	DITRANS
<i>mag-</i>		✓	✓	✓	✓
<i>ma-</i>	✓				
< <i>um</i> >	✓	✓	✓		

- *mag-* and *ma-* are in complementary distribution
 - *mag-* requires an overt, volitional external argument
 - *ma-* prohibits an overt external argument
- <*um*> overlaps in distribution with the other markers
 - <*um*> is a multi-purpose AV marker, although it is incompatible with reflexive and ditransitive roots

Kastner 2019, 2020: Voice⁰ bears a syntactic feature [$\pm D$], which governs whether an external argument must be introduced (more precisely, whether a DP must merge in the specifier of Voice) and how it is interpreted

Voice ⁰	DP in Spec-VoiceP	Semantics
Voice[+D]	Required	$\lambda x \lambda e. \text{Agent}(x, e)$
Voice[-D]	Prohibited	$\lambda P_{\langle s, t \rangle}. P$
Voice[$\emptyset$]	Unspecified	Underspecified

Applying Kastner's trivalent Voice system to Tagalog:

AV form	Voice ⁰	External argument	Semantics
<i>mag-</i>	Voice[+D]	Required	Volitional EA
<i>ma-</i>	Voice[-D]	Prohibited	No EA
<i><um></i>	Voice[$\emptyset$]	Unspecified	Unspecified

Roots are lexically specified for compatible Voice types, although there may be correlations based on lexical semantics

- (29) a. **Nag**-bukas ang guro ng pinto.
MAG.PFV-open NOM teacher GEN door
'The teacher opened the door.' *mag-*, Voice[+D]
- b. B<**um**>ukas ang pinto.
<UM>open NOM door
'The door opened.' <*um*>, Voice[Ø]
- (30) a. B<**um**>asag ang bata ng baso.
<UM>shatter NOM child GEN glass
'The child shattered a drinking glass.' <*um*>, Voice[Ø]
- b. **Na**-basag ang baso.
MA.PFV-shatter NOM baso
'The drinking glass shattered.' *ma-*, Voice[−D]

Valency morphology (Voice⁰) is distinct from Ph-voice morphology

- *m-* in *mag-*, *ma-* derives from AV <um> (Wolff 1973, Kaufman 2009)
 - <um> + *pag-* → *p<um>ag-* → *mag-*
 - <um> + *pa-* → *p<um>a-* → *ma-*
 - <um> + ∅ → <um>
- Ph-voice and valency are hosted on distinct heads
 - Locative Voice (LV) and Circumstantial Voice (CV): for some verbs, voice and Voice can receive separate exponence, e.g. *magluto* ‘to cook’

Agr ⁰		Voice[+D]	Root	
AV	<um>	<i>pag-</i>	<i>luto</i>	
PV			<i>lutu</i>	-in
LV		<i>pag-</i>	<i>lutu</i>	-an
CV	<i>i-</i>	<i>pag-</i>	<i>luto</i>	

Valency morphology (Voice⁰) is distinct from Ph-voice morphology

- *m-* in *mag-*, *ma-* derives from AV <um> (Wolff 1973, Kaufman 2009)
 - <um> + *pag-* → *p<um>ag-* → *mag-*
 - <um> + *pa-* → *p<um>a-* → *ma-*
 - <um> + ∅ → <um>
- Ph-voice and valency are hosted on distinct heads
 - Actor Voice: phonological truncation, or cumulative exponence
 - Cumulative exponence: A single marker spells out more than one feature, may be modelled with Fusion, Spanning (Svenonius 2012)

Agr ⁰		Voice ⁰		External argument
AV	<um>	Voice[+D]	<i>pag-</i>	Required
	<um>	Voice[−D]	<i>pa-</i>	Prohibited
	<um>	Voice[∅]	∅-	Unspecified

Hsieh 2020: Ph-voice resides on a head Agr^0 located above Voice^0 and below T^0

- Agr^0 is responsible for Ph-voice and assigning NOM case
- Agr^0 attaches outside of Voice^0
- Agr^0 attaches below T^0 : NOM can occur in non-finite clauses

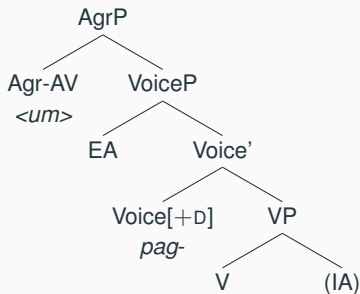
(31) [T [Agr [Voice [V]]]]

(32) B<in>a-balak ng babae=ng [PRO tulung-an *ang lalaki*]
 <PV>IPFV-plan GEN woman-LK help-LV NOM man
 'The woman is planning to help the man.' Control complement
 (Aldridge 2012: 198)

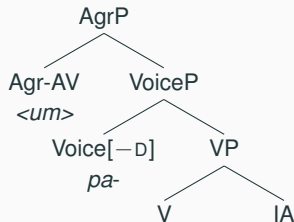
(33) B<in>uks-an ang bintana [gamit *ang susi*].
 <PFV>open-LV NOM window use NOM key
 'The window was opened using the key.' Instrument phrase

Agr ⁰		Voice ⁰		External argument
AV	<um>	Voice[+D]	<i>pag-</i>	Required
	<um>	Voice[-D]	<i>pa-</i>	Prohibited
	<um>	Voice[∅]	∅-	Unspecified

(34) Voice[+D]: <um> + *pag-* → *mag-*

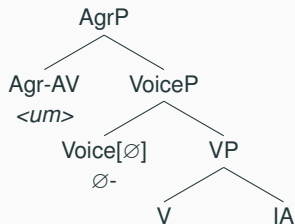
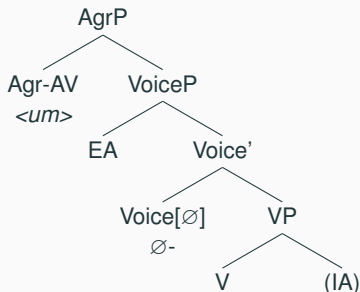


(35) Voice[-D]: <um> + *pa-* → *ma-*



Agr ⁰		Voice ⁰		External argument
	<um>	Voice[+D]	<i>pag-</i>	Required
AV	<um>	Voice[-D]	<i>pa-</i>	Prohibited
	<um>	Voice[∅]	∅-	Unspecified

(36) Voice[∅]: <um> + ∅ → <um>



Neutralizing contexts

The trivalent Voice distinction observed overtly in AV is not apparent in all constructions

Two types of neutralization:

- Morphological neutralization: Featural contrast present in the syntax is lost in the morphology
 - Recent perfective
- Syntactic neutralization: Featural contrast is lost in the syntax
 - Patient Voice, productive *pa-* causative

Recent Perfective (RPFV) is one context in which the trivalent Voice distinction is neutralized

- RPFV verb is marked by a prefix *ka-* + CV-reduplication
- RPFV clauses have no NOM argument

- (37) **Ka-lu~luto** lang ng magsasaka ng gulay.
RPFV~cook just GEN farmer GEN vegetable
'The farmer has just cooked vegetables.' *mag-* AV, Voice[+D]
- (38) **Ka-tu~tunaw** lang ng ice cream.
RPFV~melt just GEN ice cream.
'The ice cream has just melted.' *ma-* AV, Voice[−D]
- (39) **Ka-si~sipa** lang ng bata ng bola.
RPFV~kick just GEN child GEN ball
'The child has just kicked a ball.' $\emptyset$ - AV, Voice[$\emptyset$]

Verbs that are compatible with more than one flavour of Voice are ambiguous in the RPFV form

- (40) a. **Nag**-bukas ang guro ng pinto.

MAG.PFV-open NOM teacher GEN door

‘The teacher opened the door.’

mag- AV, Voice[+D]

- b. B<um>ukas ang pinto.

<um>open NOM door

‘The door opened.’

Ø- AV, Voice[Ø]

- (41) a. **Ka-bu**~bukas lang ng guro ng pinto.

RPFV~open only GEN teacher GEN door

‘The teacher has just opened the door.’

- b. **Ka-bu**~bukas lang ng pinto *nang mag-isa*.

RPFV~open only GEN door by.itself

‘The door has just opened by itself.’

There are no restrictions on the types of predicates that can appear in RPFV

- (42) **Ka-bi**~bigay ko lang ng kendi sa bata.
 RPFV~give 1SG.GEN only GEN candy OBL child
 'I have just given candy to the child.' *mag- AV, Voice[+D]*
- (43) **Ka-a**~ahit lang ng lalaki.
 RPFV~shave only GEN man
 'The man has just shaved himself.' *mag- AV, Voice[+D]*

RPFV	Type	UNACC	UNERG	TRANS	REFL	DITRANS
<i>ka- + CV</i>	Voice[+D]		✓	✓	✓	✓
<i>ka- + CV</i>	Voice[−D]	✓				
<i>ka- + CV</i>	Voice[∅]	✓	✓	✓		

RPFV exhibits morphological neutralization of trivalent Voice: Featural contrast present in the syntax is lost in the morphology

RPFV contains Voice⁰ but no Agr⁰ (Hsieh 2020)

- No Ph-voice or NOM case
- Voice⁰ is responsible for introducing external arguments
- *ka-* + CV-reduplication spells out an Aspect⁰ head above Voice (may be decomposable into inner and outer aspect)
- Morphological syncretism: No overt reflex of Voice⁰
 - Allomorphy: $\emptyset \leftrightarrow \text{Voice}[+D] / \text{RPFV } ___$
 - Impoverishment: $\text{Voice}[+D] \rightarrow \text{Voice}[\emptyset] / \text{RPFV } ___$
 - Span: $\text{ka-} \leftrightarrow [\text{RPFV } [\text{Voice}[+D]]]$

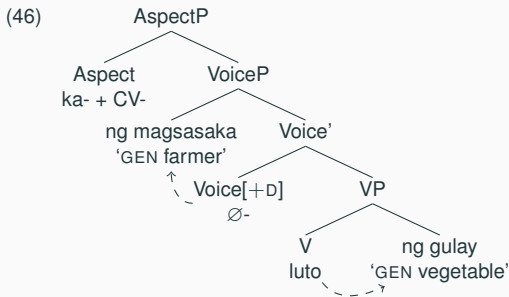
(44)	[Aspect	[Voice	[V	]]]
	RPFV	Voice[+D]	Root	
VIIs:	ka- + CV-	$\emptyset$ -	Root	

RPFV contains Voice⁰ but no Agr⁰ (Hsieh 2020)

- No Agr⁰: No Ph-voice or NOM case
- Voice⁰ assigns GEN to the EA, V⁰ assigns GEN to the IA if indefinite

(45) **Ka-lu~luto** lang ng magsasaka ng gulay.
 RPFV~cook just GEN farmer GEN vegetable
 'The farmer has just cooked vegetables.'

mag- AV, Voice[+D]



Patient Voice is another context in which trivalent Voice is neutralized

- PV, characteristically marked with *-in*, occurs in transitive constructions in which the theme is the pivot

- (47) a. **Nag**-lu~luto ang magsasaka ng gulay.
MAG-IPFV~cook NOM farmer GEN vegetable
'The farmer is cooking vegetables.' *mag- AV, Voice[+D]*
- b. Lu~lutu-**in** ng magsasaka ang gulay.
IPFV~cook-PV GEN farmer NOM vegetable
'A farmer will cook the vegetables.' *-in PV*
- (48) a. B<**um**>a~basa ang guro ng diyaryo.
<UM>IPFV~read NOM teacher GEN newspaper
'The teacher is reading a newspaper.' *Ø- AV, Voice[+D]*
- b. Ba~basa-**hin** ng guro ang diyaryo.
IPFV~read-PV GEN teacher NOM newspaper
'A teacher will read the newspaper.' *-in PV*

Reflexive and ditransitive roots are incompatible with PV

- Not simply morphological neutralization, like in the RPFV

Ditransitive

- (49) a. Bi~bigy-**an** / *Bi~bigy-**in** ko ng kendi ang bata.
FUT~give-LV FUT~give-PV 1SG.GEN GEN candy NOM child
'I will give candy to the child.'
- b. I-bi~bigay / *Bi~bigy-**in** ko ang kendi sa bata.
CV-FUT~give FUT~give-PV 1SG.GEN NOM candy OBL child
'I will give the candy to the child.'

Reflexive

- (50) A~ahit-**in** ang lalaki.
FUT~shave-PV NOM man
Non-reflexive reading: 'The man will get shaved (by someone else).'
Reflexive reading unavailable: #'The man will shave himself.'

Reflexive and ditransitive roots are incompatible with PV

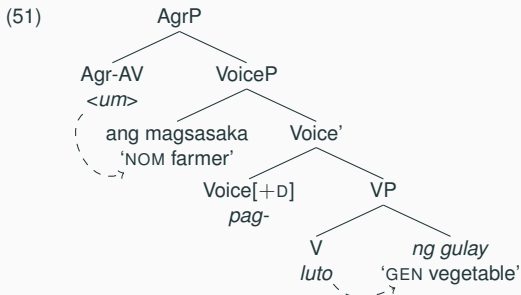
- This restriction on predicate type is reminiscent of Voice[$\emptyset$] in the Actor Voice
- PV constructions select for Voice[$\emptyset$]
- Syntactic neutralization: Featural contrast is lost in the syntax

Agr ⁰	Voice ⁰		UNACC	UNERG	TRANS	REFL	DITRANS
<um>	Voice[+D]	<i>pag-</i>		✓	✓	✓	✓
<um>	Voice[−D]	<i>pa-</i>		✓			
<um>	Voice[$\emptyset$]	$\emptyset$ -	✓	✓	✓		

Agr ⁰	Voice ⁰		UNACC	UNERG	TRANS	REFL	DITRANS
<i>-in</i>	Voice[$\emptyset$]	$\emptyset$ -			✓		

Actor Voice Agr⁰ can combine with any flavour of Voice⁰

- Voice⁰ and V⁰ assign GEN case to the EA and indefinite IA, respectively
- Agr-AV⁰ assigns NOM case to the highest argument, overwriting any previous case assignment
- Agr-AV⁰ as the default voice form (Erlewine et al. 2017)

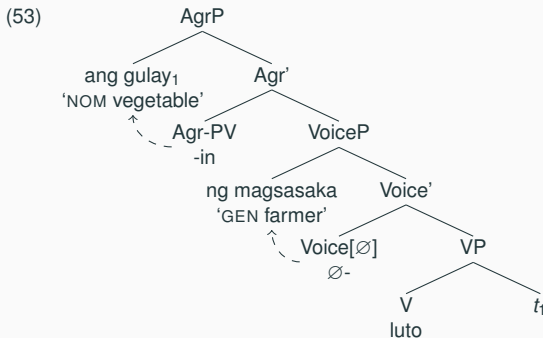


- (52) **Nag-lu~luto** ang magsasaka ng gulay.
 MAG-IPFV~cook NOM farmer GEN vegetable
 'The farmer is cooking vegetables.'

mag- AV, Voice[+D]

Patient Voice Agr⁰ selects for Voice[$\emptyset$] (Nie & Hsieh to appear)

- Definite IAs cannot be licensed by V⁰
- Agr-PV⁰ assigns NOM case to the highest unlicensed argument
- EPP feature on Agr-PV⁰ triggers Object Shift (Rackowski 2002, Aldridge 2004)



(54) Lu~luto-in ng magsasaka ang gulay.
 IPFV~cook-PV GEN farmer NOM vegetable
 'A farmer will cook the vegetables.'

-in PV, Voice[$\emptyset$]

- AV constructions overtly mark the trivalent Voice distinction
- Recent perfective involves morphological neutralization to *ka-* + CV
- Patient Voice involves syntactic neutralization to only Voice[$\emptyset$]
 - Ditransitive constructions lack a PV form due to incompatible requirements: PV requires Voice[$\emptyset$], while ditransitive roots require Voice[+D]
 - Voice[$\emptyset$] is phonologically null
- Is there evidence of neutralization to an overtly marked Voice⁰?

Productive causatives

(Nie 2020a,b)

Halkomelem Salish: Ergative VSO language spoken in British Columbia, Canada

(55) a. niʔ ʔiməʃ tθə swiwləs.

AUX walk DET boy

‘The boy walked.’

(Gerdts 2004: 769)

b. niʔ qʷəl-t-əs θə sʔeniʔ tθə səplil.

AUX bake-TR-3ERG DET woman DET bread

‘The woman baked the bread.’

c. niʔ qʷəl-əm θə sʔeniʔ ʔə tθə səplil.

AUX bake-ANTIP DET woman OBL DET bread

‘The woman baked the bread.’

(Gerdts 1980: 300)

Halkomelem productive causatives are formed with the suffix $-stəx^w$

- Only intransitive and antipassive verbs can be causativized
- Causative $-stəx^w$ occurs scopally outside of antipassive morphology

(56) a. $niʔ \quad cən \quad ʔiməʃ-stəx^w \quad tθə \quad swiwləs.$
AUX 1SBJ walk-CAUS.3OBJ DET boy
'I made the boy walk.'

b. $*niʔ \quad cən \quad q^wəl-ət-stəx^w \quad θə \quad sʔeniʔ \quad (ʔə) \quad tθə \quad səplil.$
AUX 1SBJ bake-TR-CAUS.3OBJ DET woman OBL DET bread
Intended: 'I made the woman bake the bread.'

c. $niʔ \quad cən \quad q^wəl-əm-stəx^w \quad θə \quad sʔeniʔ \quad ʔə \quad tθə \quad səplil.$
AUX 1SBJ bake-ANTIP-CAUS.3OBJ DET woman OBL DET bread
'I made the woman bake the bread.' (Gerds 2004: 769)

(57) [Caus [Voice]]

Tagalog productive causatives are formed with the prefix *pa-*

- Both intransitive and transitive predicates can be causativized
- Ph-voice morphology occurs scopally outside of causative *pa-*, reflecting the properties of the entire clause rather than the caused event

- (58) a. K<um>anta ang bata.
 <UM.PFV>read NOM child
 ‘The child sang.’
- b. Nag-**pa**-kanta ako ng bata.
 MAG.PFV-CAUS-sing 1SG.NOM GEN child
 ‘I made a child sing.’
- c. P<in>**a**-kanta-Ø ko ang bata.
 <PFV>CAUS-sing-PV 1SG.GEN NOM child
 ‘I made the child sing.’

Tagalog productive causatives are formed with the prefix *pa-*

- Both intransitive and transitive predicates can be causativized
- Ph-voice morphology occurs scopally outside of causative *pa-*, reflecting the properties of the entire clause rather than the caused event

- (59) a. *Nag-pa-basa* si Luz kay Kiko ng libro.
MAG.PFV-CAUS-read NOM.PN Luz OBL.PN Kiko GEN book
'Luz made Kiko read a book.' AV causative
- b. *P<in>a-basa-Ø* ni Luz si Kiko ng libro.
<PFV>CAUS-read-PV GEN.PN Luz NOM.PN Kiko GEN book
'Luz made Kiko read a book.' PV causative
- c. *I-p<in>a-basa* ni Luz kay Kiko ang libro.
CV-<PFV>CAUS-read GEN.PN Luz OBL.PN Kiko NOM book
'Luz made Kiko read the book.' CV causative

- (60) [Voice [Caus]]

Morphological decomposition of the causative forms:

Agr ⁰		Voice ⁰		(Caus ⁰)	Root
AV	<um>	pag-	pa-		basa
PV		∅-	pa-		basa -in
CV	i-	∅-	pa-		basa

- Voice⁰ displays evidence of at least a two-way distinction: Voice[+D] in AV, Voice[∅] in PV and CV
- Caus⁰ strikingly has the same form as Voice[−D]

Agr ⁰		Voice ⁰		External argument
AV	<um>	Voice[+D]	<i>pag-</i>	Required
	<um>	Voice[−D]	<i>pa-</i>	Prohibited
	<um>	Voice[∅]	∅-	Unspecified

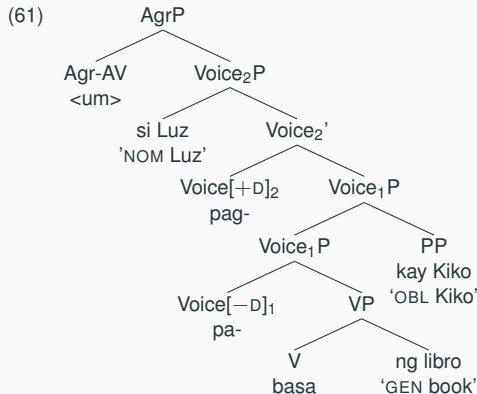
Nie 2020a,b: Tagalog causatives have a Voice over Voice structure

- *pa-* is the spell-out of a lower Voice rather than a dedicated causative head

Agr ⁰		Voice ₂ ⁰	Voice ₁ ⁰	Root	
AV	<um>	pag-	pa-	basa	
PV		∅-	pa-	basa	-in
CV	i-	∅-	pa-	basa	

- Voice₂⁰ displays evidence of at least a two-way distinction: Voice[+D] in AV, Voice[∅] in PV and CV
- Voice₁⁰ displays syntactic neutralization, is always Voice[−D] (see also Nash 2020 on Georgian)
- Causative meaning emerges from building Voice over Voice

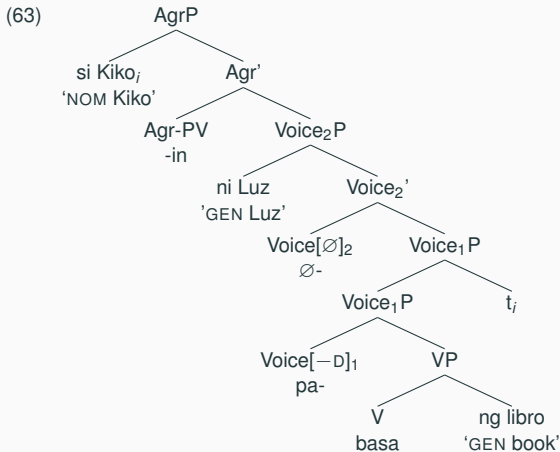
AV causative: [Voice[+D] [Voice[−D]]]



- (62) *Nag-pa-basa* *si Luz* (*kay Kiko*) *ng libro.*
 MAG.PFV-CAUS-read NOM.PN Luz OBL.PN Kiko GEN book
 'Luz made Kiko/someone read a book.'

AV causative

PV causative: [Voice[$\emptyset$] [Voice[$-D$]]]

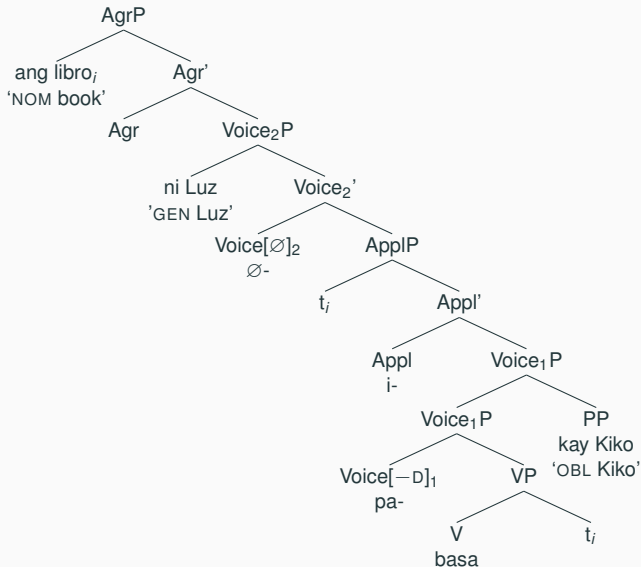


- (64) Pa~**pa**-basa-hin ni Luz si Kiko ng libro.
 IPFV~CAUS-read-PV GEN.PN Luz NOM.PN Kiko GEN book
 'Luz will make Kiko read a book.'

PV causative

CV causative: [Voice[$\emptyset$] [Appl [Voice[$-D$]]]]

(65)



Summary and outlook

- Philippine-type voice and valency associated with Voice⁰ are hosted on different heads
- AV constructions transparently show a three-way morphological contrast on Voice⁰ that is distinct from Agr⁰
 - Valency morphology associated with Voice⁰ identified in related languages: Chen 2022 on Puyuma *u-* and Tan 2023 on Amarasi *ma-*
- We have focused on distinguishing Agr⁰ and Voice⁰ in AV and PV, but what about Agr⁰ and Appl⁰ in LV and CV?
 - Nie 2019 proposed a system with Voice⁰ and Appl⁰ but no Agr⁰
- Ph-voice is at least as high as Agr⁰, but its precise location may differ across languages

Thank you! Maraming salamat!



Research reported in this presentation was supported by the Division of Research and Innovation at San José State University under Award Number 23-RSG-07-070. The content is solely the responsibility of the author and does not necessarily represent the official views of San José State University.

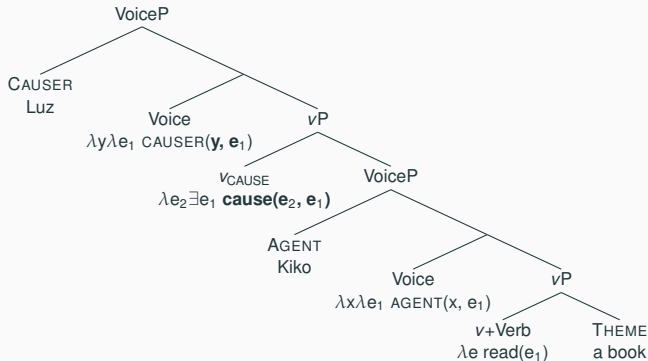
This research was supported in part by funding from the Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada.

Appendix

Nie 2020a: Two fundamentally different ways of forming productive causatives

- Bi-eventive causatives: Formed by adding a causing event
 - Two event-introducing heads in the syntax
 - Causal relation holds between two events
- Mono-eventive causatives: Formed by adding a causer argument
 - One event-introducing head in the syntax
 - Causal relation holds between an event and an argument

(66) Causing event introduced by CAUSE-*v*



Manner adverbs

Context 1: Cinderella doesn't know how to dance but wants to impress at the ball.
Fairy Godmother gives her the power to dance beautifully.

- (67) P<in>a-sayaw-Ø *nang maganda* ni Fairy Godmother
 <PFV>CAUS-dance-PV ADV beautiful GEN Fairy Godmother
 si Cinderella.
 NOM.PN Cinderella
 'Fairy Godmother made Cinderella **dance** *beautifully*.'

Context 2: Cinderella doesn't want to dance at the ball. Fairy Godmother makes her dance with a beautiful spell.

Intended: 'Fairy Godmother *beautifully* **made** Cinderella dance.'

Manner adverbs

Context 1: A student in the school play is saying his lines too quietly. The teacher makes him talk loudly.

- (68) P<in>a-salita-Ø nang malakas ng guro ang bata.
 <PFV>CAUS-talk-PV ADV loud GEN teacher NOM child
 'The teacher made the child **talk loudly**.'

Context 2: A student in the school play forgets that it is his line. The teacher shouts at him to get him to talk.

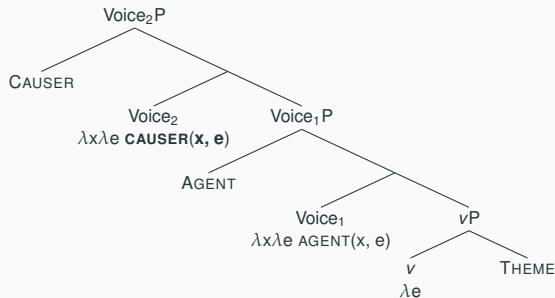
Intended: 'The teacher *loudly* **made** the child talk.'

Time-related adverbs

Context: Luz learns that her daughter Maria will miss the race this week, so tomorrow she will register Maria to run next week.

- (69) (**Bukas*) pa~**pa-takbu**-hin ni Luz (**bukas*)
tomorrow IPFV~CAUS-run-PV GEN.PN Luz tomorrow
si Maria sa *susunod na linggo*.
NOM.PN Maria OBL next LK week
'(**Tomorrow*,) Luz will **make** Maria **run** *next week*.'

(70) Voice directly embeds another Voice



(71) $\llbracket \text{Voice} \rrbracket \leftrightarrow \lambda x \lambda e \text{ CAUSER}(x, e) / \text{__ Voice}$

(72) $\llbracket \text{Voice} \rrbracket \leftrightarrow \lambda x \lambda e \text{ AGENT}(x, e)$

Agent-oriented adverbs

(73) Um-iyak si Kiko nang sinasadya.
AV.PFV-cry NOM.PN Kiko ADV deliberately
'Kiko **cried** *deliberately*.'

(74) P<in>a-iyak-Ø ko si Kiko nang sinasadya.
<PFV>CAUS-cry-PV 1SG.GEN NOM.PN Kiko ADV deliberately
'I made Kiko *deliberately* **cry**.' /
'I *deliberately* **made** Kiko cry.'

- Supports an analysis of the Tagalog causee as an agent introduced by Voice rather than e.g. a recipient introduced by an Applicative head

References

- Aldridge, Edith. 2004. *Ergativity and word order in Austronesian languages*: Cornell University dissertation.
- Aldridge, Edith. 2012. Antipassive and ergativity in Tagalog. *Lingua* 122(3). 192–203.
- Chen, Victoria. 2022. When Philippine-type voice meets Indo-European-type voice: Insights from Puyuma. *Journal of East Asian Linguistics* 31(4). 517–550.
- Cruz, Emilita L. 1975. *A subcategorization of Tagalog verbs*. Quezon City, Philippines: University of the Philippines.
- Erlewine, Michael Yoshitaka, Theodore Levin & Coppe van Urk. 2017. Ergativity and Austronesian-Type Voice Systems, vol. 1, Oxford University Press. doi:10.1093/oxfordhb/9780198739371.013.16.
- Gerdts, D. 1980. Antipassives and causatives in Halkomelem. In *Proceedings of BLS* 6. 300–314.
- Gerdts, D. 2004. Combinatory conditions on Halkomelem causatives. *Linguistics* 42. 767–789.
- Hsieh, Henrison. 2020. *Beyond nominative: A broader view of a'-dependencies in tagalog*. McGill University dissertation.
- Kastner, Itamar. 2019. Templatic morphology as an emergent property: Roots and functional heads in Hebrew. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 37. 571–619.
- Kastner, Itamar. 2020. *Voice at the interfaces: The syntax, semantics, and morphology of the Hebrew verb*. Language Science Press.
- Kaufman, Daniel. 2009. On **pa-*, **pa<R>-* and **pa<ŋ>-*. Talk handout, presented at the 11th International Conference on Austronesian Linguistics.
- Kratzer, A. 1996. Severing the External Argument from its Verb. In J. Rooryck & L. Zaring (eds.), *Phrase Structure and the Lexicon*, 109–137. Dordrecht: Kluwer.

- Levin, Beth & Malka Rappaport Hovav. 1994. *Unaccusativity: At the syntax-lexical semantics interface*, vol. 26. MIT press.
- Nash, Léa. 2020. Causees are not Agents. In Elitzur A. Bar-Asher Siegal & Nora Boneh (eds.), *Perspectives on Causation*, 349–394. Cham: Springer International Publishing. doi:10.1007/978-3-030-34308-8_11.
- Nie, Yining. 2019. Raising applicatives and possessors in Tagalog. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 4(1). 139. doi:10.5334/gjgl.941.
- Nie, Yining. 2020a. *Licensing arguments*: New York University dissertation.
- Nie, Yining. 2020b. Morphological causatives are voice over voice. *Word Structure* 13(1). 102–126.
- Nie, Yining & Henrison Hsieh. to appear. Tagalog valency morphology and its neutralization. In *Proceedings of AFLA 30*.
- Pittman, Richard S. 1966. Tagalog -um- and mag-: An interim report. *Linguistic Circle of Canberra Publications* A(8). 9–20.
- Rackowski, Andrea. 2002. *The structure of Tagalog: Specificity, voice, and the distribution of arguments*: MIT dissertation.
- Schachter, Paul & Fe T Otones. 1972. *Tagalog reference grammar*. Berkeley, CA: University of California Press.
- Svenonius, Peter. 2012. *Spanning*.
- Tan, Tamisha Lauren Ming Hui. 2023. *Voice and valency in Amarasi: Topics in synchronic and diachronic morphosyntax*: Harvard University dissertation.

- Travis, Lisa. 2000. The L-syntax/S-syntax boundary: Evidence from Austronesian. In Ileana Paul, Vivianne Phillips & Lisa Travis (eds.), *Formal issues in Austronesian linguistics*, vol. 49 (Studies in Natural Language and Linguistic Theory), 167–194. Dordrecht: Springer Science+Business Media. doi:10.1007/978-94-017-1580-5.
- Travis, Lisa. 2010. *Inner aspect: The articulation of VP*, vol. 80 (Studies in Natural Language and Linguistic Theory). Springer. doi:10.1007/978-90-481-8550-4.
- Wolff, John U. 1973. Verbal inflection in Proto-Austronesian. In Andrew Gonzalez (ed.), *Parangal kay Cecilio Lopez: Philippine Journal of Linguistics Special Monograph Issue*, vol. 4, 71–91. Quezon City: Linguistic Society of the Philippines.